Being the Articles Composing the Lords of Light Charter

Preamble:

Being a body concerned with the acquisition and correct dispersal of lore, history, artifacts, and other such lost knowledges, the group known as the Lords of Light shall make it their affair to insure that those knowledges that may be lost be instead brought to the attention of the world, that they may fulfill their proper purpose. The overriding goal of all members must be the acquisition of said knowledge, and the insurance that it shall be used as each piece most warrants, whether that be to hand the most infernal device over to the gods to do with as they see fit, or to leave a piece of lore to rot. All knowledge must be made to realize its destiny in the grand scheme that is the world.

Article the First:
The Governing Body and Divisions

Just as knowledge is composed of many facets of existence, from the material to the philosophical, so must a society dedicated to the Light of Knowledge be composed of many facets. While unified, each member of the society is assumed and expected to have individual goals and motivations that are in alignment with their fellows. It is the responsibility of the Governing Body to insure that all members have the opportunity to have their efforts facilitated by the society itself. This facilitation, however, is limited only to dispersal of Guild resources, which are primarily limited to the knowledge collected by its members. In the case of the recovery of a material artifact of power by the society, its dispersal is decided as described below.

At the head of the society is the Prime Illuminatus, the First Light. The responsibilities of the Prime Illuminatus include, but are not limited to, the following:

A) The Prime Illuminatus is expected to be fervent in the search for new knowledge of all types. In addition, the Prime Illuminatus is privy to ALL information gained by the society, that he or she may best advise the society's members insofar as a best course of action. Advice regarding guild resources is final, unless over-ruled by a 2/3 majority vote by a 2/3 quorum of the society members. The Prime Illuminatus is responsible for directing the society as a whole, and may assign leadership positions as he or she sees fit, and at a whim. The Prime Illuminatus may also accept qualified recruits as members, and expulse existing members from the society at a whim. The Prime Illuminatus may only be deposed by a 2/3 majority of a full attendance of the society, at which point the society may be dissolved, or leadership may be handed to another, at the discretion of the Prime Illuminatus. It is decreed herein that the first Prime Illuminatus shall be Elling, Paladin of Erollisi Marr, for his vision and the ambition to create this society.

B) Within the society shall exist Orders, dedicated to the various pursuits of knowledge. Each of these Orders shall be proposed by a meeting of the society, and enacted upon their creation and approval by a 2/3 majority of a 2/3 quorum. Leadership shall be given to the proposing member of the Order. To form an Order requires at least three members of the Society join them at the time of inception, in addition to a completely stated purpose, and list of intentions, to be added to this charter upon approval. Orders have no

particular power, unless granted by the Prime Illuminatus, and exist as an organizational tool. The heads of the Orders shall form an advisor council to the Prime Illuminatus, and will be expected to maintain complete and full notes and information regarding their tasks, as well as ample documentation regarding their exploits, that the Prime Illuminatus may evaluate each Order as time passes.

C) Under the Prime Illuminatus shall exist a body of Archons, who shall enact the will of the Prime Illuminatus within the world. The Archons shall be chosen by the Prime Illuminatus at his discretion. The Archons are assumed to speak with the same authority as the Prime Illuminatus on Guild matters, and should be treated accordingly. Archons may only be deposed at the discretion of the Prime Illuminatus, or by a tribunal vote of a 2/3 majority of a 2/3 quorum. In return for their privilege, however, the Archons forfeit their vote in guild matters upon their appointment to the station. In addition, poor behavior on the part of an Archon reflects directly upon the Prime Illuminatus, and can lead to action being taken against the Prime Illuminatus as a result.

Article the Second:
Membership Within the Lords of Light

Requirements for membership are as described below:

A) Each prospective member must have a sponsor from the Lords of Light. This sponsor may be of any standing within the guild, and will understand the responsibilities of sponsoring a potential recruit. Actions of that recruit reflect directly upon the judgement of the sponsor, but will not be taken as seriously as when the potential recruit is offered membership. When the recruit is deemed worthy of membership, he or she will be brought before the Prime Illuminatus for acceptance. No member of the Lords of Light may bring a member into the society's folds without the approval of the Prime Illuminatus, and doing so can result in expulsion from the society. During the time of sponsorship, the recruit is to be taught the tenets of the Lords of Light, and the responsibilities of its members. No recruit should enter the service of the guild with any darkness clouding their judgement, and sponsorship should not be a short thing, in order to test the fortitude and patience of potential recruits.

B) Each recruit must bring with them some contribution to the Guild resources, being a piece of knowledge, an artifact, or some similar item of lost lore. This need not be something new to the Society, simply an item proving the recruit's ability to function on their own in a capacity conducive to a strong presence within the society.

C) Each recruit must demonstrate an understanding of the oath which binds the Lords of Light together, and take this oath, upon signing the charter in his or her own blood.

As well, existing members have rules which they must abide by.

A) No member shall knowingly impede by action another's search for knowledge, unless such a search has been prohibited by those who have found the knowledge already. At the bidding of the Prime Illuminatus, knowledge, lore, artifacts, or other such items may be declared prohibited in the interests of maintaining the integrity of the Guild and our world. Items may only be prohibited once they have been found, and must be catalogued that all may know that the illumination of their existence has already bathed the Lords of Light.

B) No member shall knowingly impede by action another's quest for personal fulfillment whose fruits may be realized with the knowledge, lore, history, artifacts, or similar items, obtained by the Lords of Light.

C) No non-ranked member may demand any aid of any kind from another member and expect retribution if such aid is not granted. No member is obligated to give help to any other non-ranking member of the Lords of Light. No ranking

member may make demands of any other member of the Lords of Light that does not directly relate to Guild business, and to do so is grounds for being stripped of rank and expulsed from the society. The bonds of friendship are not what holds this body together.

D) All members are expected to follow the orders of their ranking superiors when pertaining to Guild business of any kind. Failure to do so is grounds for retribution, including, but not limited to, fines, penance, or expulsion from the guild. Punishment shall be determined by the Prime Illuminatus or an official appointed by the Prime Illuminatus.

E) Ranking members may not demand the endangerment of life and limb, nor monetary compensation of any kind, from the members of the Lords of Light. The exception to this rules is the future institution of Guild dues in the event they become necessary for the purchase or maintenance of a guild headquarters, or any fees voted on by a 2/3 majority of a full attendance.

F) No member shall be forced at any time to be a member of the Lords of Light. If conditions are unacceptable to a member, that member is free to quit at any time, without retribution from the Guild. It is expected, however, that all confidential knowledge be respected, and that the integrity of the guild is not endangered by the knowledge this person may have.

G) No member shall ever reveal knowledge, lore, history, artifact, or other such item determined to be confidential, dangerous, or secret by the Prime Illuminatus or one of his Archons. While a body bound to the presentation of the Light of Knowledge to our world, some Light is bright enough to blind those unprepared for it.

Article the Third:
Summation and Statement of Purpose

The spirit of these rules is the protection and fulfillment of the members of the Lords of Light. This, above all else, shall be used to determine the worthiness of these rules in the future, and shall guide the Lords of Light in amending their own rules as time goes on. No leader shall be a tyrant, and no member shall abuse its fellows. At the same time, all must respect the vision of the Prime Illuminatus, and understand that some decisions are made with reasons that must remain obscure, and so must we understand that though our fellows cannot demand our help, it is our duty, as their brothers and sisters in our search for enlightenment, to aid them in every way we can.

We, as the Lords of Light, exist to bring forth those things shrouded by the darkness of time and misfortune. All of us, for whatever reason, have the need to uncover the past, and the mysteries it holds. This is why we are together. Our shared motivation is to retrieve that which is lost, and protect it from becoming lost again. Through knowledge, we will find enlightenment, and we will find the realization of our individual ambitions through a collective effort to find this enlightenment. Our road is wide, with room for many to travel upon it. But our road is also shrouded in the darkness of mystery, muddled by the rains of time, and overgrown by the weeds sown by countless careless individuals. Our enemy is ignorance. Ignorance makes some strong, and is a powerful weapon that can be used against us. In driving it from the world, we will make more enemies. The light of knowledge shall hold us together, and in unity, we shall persevere over all who would oppose us, and bring unto this world a new age of enlightenment where all can achieve their destiny.

I hold the Light of Knowledge in my hands.
In a world of the blind, I can see.
With my sight, I shall aid those who cannot.
My search for truth is never-ending.
I shall share my vision with my Colleagues at all times.
I shall never obscure the truth that will benefit the world.
I shall never abuse the Light of Knowledge that I hold.

And I shall show the wisdom to know
How much light is enough
To show the way of truth
To those who are lost in darkness
And how much is enough
To blind them forever.